

HOUSE No. 3593

The Commonwealth of Massachusetts

PRESENTED BY:

Hadley Luddy

To the Honorable Senate and House of Representatives of the Commonwealth of Massachusetts in General Court assembled:

The undersigned legislators and/or citizens respectfully petition for the adoption of the accompanying bill:

An Act relative to the position of poet laureate for the Commonwealth of Massachusetts.

PETITION OF:

NAME:	DISTRICT/ADDRESS:	DATE ADDED:
<i>Hadley Luddy</i>	<i>4th Barnstable</i>	<i>1/15/2025</i>

HOUSE No. 3593

By Representative Luddy of Orleans, a petition (accompanied by bill, House, No. 3593) of Hadley Luddy for legislation to create the position of poet laureate of the Commonwealth. Tourism, Arts and Cultural Development.

[SIMILAR MATTER FILED IN PREVIOUS SESSION
SEE HOUSE, NO. 4311 OF 2023-2024.]

The Commonwealth of Massachusetts

In the One Hundred and Ninety-Fourth General Court
(2025-2026)

An Act relative to the position of poet laureate for the Commonwealth of Massachusetts.

Be it enacted by the Senate and House of Representatives in General Court assembled, and by the authority of the same, as follows:

1 Chapter 6 of the General Laws, as appearing in the 2016 official edition, is hereby
2 amended by inserting after Section 38, the following section:-

3 Section 38A. (a) Biennially, on or before March 31, the governor may appoint a poet
4 laureate for the commonwealth of Massachusetts from a list of nominees submitted by the poet
5 laureate nominating committee pursuant to subsection (b). The poet laureate shall seek to raise
6 the consciousness of all commonwealth residents, especially school children, to a greater
7 appreciation of the reading and writing of poetry. The poet laureate shall be appointed to serve
8 for a term of 2 years or until a successor is appointed and qualified as provided in this section. In
9 the event of a vacancy in the office of poet laureate, the vacancy shall be filled in the same
10 manner as the original appointment.

11 (b) There shall be a poet laureate nominating committee consisting of the following 5
12 members: the speaker of the house of representatives, or a designee; the senate president, or a
13 designee; 2 members appointed by the governor; and the executive director of the Massachusetts
14 center for the book, or a designee. Members of the poet laureate nominating committee shall
15 serve without compensation.

16 (c) The poet laureate nominating committee shall advertise and receive nominations for
17 the selection of the poet laureate for the commonwealth of Massachusetts. Nominees shall be
18 residents of the commonwealth and shall provide biographical and professional information, as
19 well as supporting representative material, explaining why, based on their poetic
20 accomplishments, they deserve recognition as the poet laureate for commonwealth of
21 Massachusetts. The poet laureate nominating committee shall review all nominations and select
22 3 nominees to submit to the governor biennially on or before February 1.

23 (d) The person appointed to the position of poet laureate may receive remuneration
24 through the Massachusetts center for the book. The Massachusetts center for the book may
25 establish an appropriate stipend for the poet laureate and may provide for the payment of the poet
26 laureate's expenses incurred in fulfilling of their responsibilities, subject to appropriation.